RIDGEPEAK | INDEPENDENT APPLICANT RESEARCH

Texas Residential Services: Acquisition Pipeline

30 publicly identified service operators, evidence-led market screening and a proposed next-step diligence plan.

AS OF NOVEMBER 4, 2026

Research package 01 | SOURCING BRIEF

IMPORTANT: This is an independent analyst work sample. It is not affiliated with, authorized by, or prepared for Ridgepeak Partners or Fortress Service Partners. Research candidates are not confirmed sellers. No candidate has been contacted. All private-company financials are unavailable; financial modeling is illustrative only.

Executive assessment

Fortress describes a buy-and-build network of locally branded residential service businesses. Ridgepeak has publicly listed Fortress as a portfolio company. We assembled 30 first-party sourced Texas company leads across the Austin/Central Texas, San Antonio, Dallas-Fort Worth and Houston areas. The objective is to identify companies warranting qualification, not to assert that they are for sale.

Preliminary result: prioritize Central Texas multi-trade or residential repair-and-maintenance operators for additional research. Do not extrapolate revenue, margins, owner liquidity needs, or seller receptivity from web descriptions.

Sector investment perspective

- Market demand: HVAC, electrical and plumbing include essential repair work, but equipment replacement and discretionary project work can introduce cyclicality.
- Capstone Partners reported 223 residential services deals in its 2026 year-to-date coverage, with financial sponsors at 60.5% and HVAC/plumbing/electrical representing 19.3% of covered volume.
- Technician recruitment, dispatch productivity, service agreement retention and geographic density are critical diligence drivers; these metrics are not yet available for the prospects.
- The acquisition thesis depends on a credible multi-year field-operations integration plan, not on multiple expansion alone.

Scoring methodology

Analyst ratings use five 1-to-5 scales based on observable public descriptions: recurring-service relevance (20%), residential fit (30%), Austin adjacency (20%), named operator evidence (15%), and source confidence (15%). The formula is editable in the companion Excel workbook. Every score is a public-information research prioritization, not a valuation or likelihood-of-sale assessment.

Top 12 research leads by screening score

#	Operator	Texas market	Score / 5	Service offering
1	Woods Comfort Systems	Austin / Central Texas	4.85	HVAC, Plumbing
2	SALT Service Co.	Austin / Central Texas	4.70	Electrical, HVAC, Plumbing, Generators
3	ABA Heating & Cooling	Austin	4.65	HVAC
4	Air Comfort Systems	Austin / Hill Country	4.65	HVAC
5	Efficient AC, Electric & Plumbing	Austin	4.55	HVAC, Electrical, Plumbing
6	Aquarius Home Service	Houston / Sugar Land	4.45	HVAC, Plumbing
7	Beyer Plumbing / Beyer Air Conditioning	San Antonio	4.35	Plumbing, HVAC
8	Comfort-Air Engineering & Primo Plumbing	San Antonio	4.35	HVAC, Plumbing
9	Johnny Rooter Plumbing	Austin	4.35	Plumbing
10	Texas Home Performance	Pflugerville / Austin	4.35	HVAC
11	Triple A AC, Heating & Plumbing	Flower Mound / DFW	4.30	HVAC, Plumbing
12	All Cool A/C & Heating	Fort Bend / Houston	4.25	HVAC

Source URLs for every entry, research flags and unverified leadership claims appear in screening_pipeline_30.csv and evidence_register.csv. Scores are not cross-company financial comparisons.

Strategic fit is not seller readiness. SALT and Efficient are excluded from immediate outreach based on public owner statements (see p. 3).

Priority qualifications and stop signs

Woods Comfort Systems: lead for *research qualification*, not an acquisition recommendation

The Woods website describes the Central Texas business as operating since 2008, led by Christopher Alan Woods, and serving HVAC and plumbing customers. The business emphasizes independence and has not publicly disclosed verifiable EBITDA or transaction intent. Investigate service agreement mix, operational scale, owner goals and labor economics before modeling as a real target.

Air Comfort Systems: focused residential repair and service profile

Air Comfort Systems describes its founding in 2015 by Carlos and Gisselle Gonzales, with service coverage from Austin into the Hill Country. It has a direct residential HVAC profile, but there is no validated financial, license, labor or seller-sentiment information.

SALT and Efficient: public opposition to a change in ownership

SALT says it is not for sale. Efficient says its owners have no plans to change local ownership. Both retain high strategic-fit scores but are excluded from immediate outreach. These are company-reported positions that may change.

Thirty-company research coverage

By design, the broader longlist spans both clean residential operators and several mixed/commercial businesses. Commercial-oriented leads are retained as comparators or lower-priority screens rather than quietly excluded. It is not appropriate to present these leads as verified proprietary outreach.

Next 30-day acquisition diligence sequence

- Week 1: independently verify corporate entities, licenses, operating geography, and signs of existing institutional ownership. Exclude contradicted leads.
- Week 2: collect customer mix, maintenance program indicators, hiring history, public permits where appropriate and competitive density.
- Week 3: construct a 10-company qualification shortlist with seller-partnership narrative and evidence-backed potential objections.
- Week 4: if authorized by Ridgepeak, develop respectful, bespoke owner outreach and request high-level operational metrics; never imply investor affiliation in independent outreach.

Sources and research transparency

https://www.fortressservicepartners.com/
https://careerdesign.dartmouth.edu/jobs/ridgepeak-partners-business-development-analyst-deal-sourcing/
https://www.capstonepartners.com/insights/report-residential-services-ma-update/
https://woodscomfortsystems.com/about-us/
https://www.aircomfortaustin.com/about-us/
https://callsalt.com/why-salt-stays-privately-owned/
https://efficienttexas.com/about/
https://data.texas.gov/dataset/TDLR-All-Licenses/7358-krk7/data
https://tsbpe.texas.gov/free-licensee-list/